

Flexible Work Schedule Policy

Policy ID	HR-WORK-302	Owner	People Operations
Effective	January 1, 2026	Next review	January 1, 2027
Status	Current	Classification	Internal
Audience	Employees and people managers	Company	Northstar Technologies (fictional)

Document notice: This policy is fictional and was created for retrieval-augmented generation testing. It is not legal, tax, medical, or employment advice.

1. Purpose and Scope

This policy covers flexible start and end times, compressed schedules, temporary schedule changes, time recording, and coverage expectations. It addresses when work occurs; the Remote and Hybrid Work Policy addresses where work occurs.

This policy applies across company offices and approved remote locations unless a local addendum or controlling law provides a different rule. Employees should use the current policy version and ask the listed owner when facts do not fit the standard case.

2. Summary of Key Rules

Schedule	Example	Approval	Trial period
Flexible hours	8:00-4:30 or 9:30-6:00	Manager	30 days
Compressed week	Four 10-hour days	Department head and HR	60 days
Temporary change	Up to 10 workdays	Manager	Not required

3. Core Coverage

Teams must maintain customer and operational coverage. Unless a department publishes different hours, employees should be available for meetings from 10:00 a.m. to 3:00 p.m. in the team's primary time zone. Flexible schedules do not reduce expected weekly hours, alter job duties, or permit an employee to miss mandatory meetings without approval.

4. Overtime and Meal Periods

Overtime-eligible employees must record actual start, stop, and meal times. A flexible schedule cannot be used to average overtime across weeks where prohibited. Employees must take legally required meal and rest periods. Managers may not encourage off-the-clock work to preserve a preferred schedule.

5. Review and Withdrawal

Recurring arrangements begin with the trial period shown in the schedule table. Managers review attendance, service levels, collaboration, and workload. An arrangement may be modified or withdrawn with reasonable notice when business needs change. Immediate changes may be required for security events, emergency coverage, or a failure to record time accurately.

6. Relationship to Other Programs

A flexible schedule is not automatically a remote-work agreement, leave approval, or disability accommodation. Employees seeking a location change must follow the Remote and Hybrid Work Policy. Employees needing a schedule adjustment for a medical or religious reason should contact People Operations for the appropriate accommodation process.

7. Exceptions, Records, and Questions

Exceptions must be lawful, documented, limited in duration, and approved by the policy owner plus any other owner named in the relevant section. Approval for one case does not change the policy for other employees. Records are retained according to the company retention schedule and any legal hold.

Related documents: Remote and Hybrid Work Policy; Annual Leave and Company Holidays Policy; Workplace Accommodation Procedure.

Version history

Version	Effective date	Change
1.0	January 1, 2026	Initial fictional policy issued for RAG evaluation.